Fluent Forward

FREE CHECK · PAGE 1: FIND YOUR NUMBER

For UK law firm partners, practice managers & finance leads

The Law Firm WIP-to-Cash Check: how much of your WIP will never be billed?

Work your team has already done, sitting in WIP or written off at bill stage, is money that has been earned but is not turning into cash. This check shows how to find your own figure from your own WIP and billing reports.

You need: Your WIP report and last quarter's bills, from your practice-management or time-recording system. No confidential records leave your business.

1. **Run your WIP report.** As at today, by matter, showing unbilled time value and the date of the oldest unbilled entry.
2. **Filter for WIP older than 90 days.** Or the age your firm agrees. Total the unbilled value. That is Box A.
3. **Add last quarter's bill-stage write-offs.** For bills raised last quarter, total recorded time value minus the amount billed. That is Box B.
4. **Set aside WIP that is meant to be long-running.** For example, where staged or end-of-matter billing has been agreed with the client. List it separately so it isn't treated as stuck.
5. **Note why billing has stalled on the rest.** Time not finalised, awaiting fee-earner review, client query, no agreed billing point, or something else.

A · Unbilled WIP older than 90 days (excluding agreed long-running matters)	£
B · Time written off at bill stage last quarter	£
Work already done that isn't turning into cash (A + B)	£

Count each item once. If aged WIP was later billed and written down, include it in B only. This is your own number from your own records. We don't publish averages or benchmarks for it.

> Billing and write-off decisions stay with the responsible fee earner or partner. This check is about visibility, not about overriding that judgement. It uses WIP and billing reports only; no client account records are needed.

PAGE 2: WORKED EXAMPLE

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How the check works on one month's records

FICTIONAL EXAMPLE · FIRM A (FICTIONAL)

This organisation, its records and every figure on this page are invented to show the method. They are not typical results, averages or benchmarks, and they don't describe any real business. Your own figures will differ.

Matter type	WIP age	Unbilled value	Why it has stalled	Counted in A?
Commercial property	140 days	**£8,400**	Time awaiting partner review	Yes
Employment advisory	120 days	**£3,150**	No agreed billing point	Yes
Probate	210 days	**£12,600**	Billing on completion agreed with client	No, set aside
Commercial litigation	95 days	**£5,700**	Client query on last bill	Yes
Corporate	100 days	**£2,250**	Time entries not finalised	Yes

A · Aged WIP counted	£19,500
B · Bill-stage write-offs last quarter	£6,300
Fictional total (A + B)	**£25,800**

The £12,600 probate matter is long-running by agreement, so it is listed but not counted.

> Using your own numbers: repeat the steps on page 1, then copy each item into the action queue on page 3 so every one has an owner, evidence and a date.

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PAGE 3: MONTHLY ACTION QUEUE

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One line per item, reviewed monthly

Typical items: an aged matter, a write-off to review, a time-entry chase, a pre-bill pack to prepare.

Item	Amount (£)	Owner	Evidence	Next action	Date

Month: _____ Reviewed by: _____ Total open (£): _____

PAGE 4: WHAT DONE-FOR-YOU LOOKS LIKE

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Want it run for you each month?

If you'd rather not run this yourself every month, we run it for you as a service. It's done by people, not software you have to buy and set up. Each month, we:

- Pull the WIP and write-off reports on a set day.
- Build the aged-WIP list matter by matter, with the reason each one has stalled.
- Chase outstanding time entries and prepare pre-bill packs for fee-earner review.
- Send a one-page monthly summary: aged WIP, write-offs, and what moved since last month.

What stays with you

Every billing and write-off decision stays with your fee earners and partners. We handle the administrative side.

What we'd need

A monthly export or read-only access to the reports named on page 1, and one named contact. Scope and terms are agreed in writing before we start.

What it isn't

Not a software licence, not a promise of any amount recovered, and not legal, tax or financial advice. If the check shows nothing worth fixing, we'll say so.

Optional: a free 15-minute call about unbilled WIP and bill-stage write-offs

If this is a live issue for your firm, we'll look at your process with you and how we'd run it for you. No obligation.

Book a 15-minute WIP-to-cash call for your firm

cal.com/matthew-todd/wip-to-cash-law